

BUILD HANDOFF

What we built, and what's needed to take Stripe & Resend live.

WHAT WE BUILT

The Pakistani Creative Collective platform is a Next.js app with a Postgres database (Supabase), styled to the brand spec (colors, fonts, logo, illustrations) with the full creative-profile and contact-request experience implemented.

Public site

- Home page, member directory (free preview vs. full paid view), and individual creative profiles.
- **Free visitors** see: name, role(s), experience level, location, bio, and one public link.
- **Paid subscribers** additionally see: headshot, education, languages, mediums, social/portfolio links, primary work sample, and a "Work For Hire" card (rate info, travel, collaboration preferences).

Creative application flow

- Public "Apply to Join" form (free) → admin review queue → approve/reject → applicant is emailed and gets a live profile.

Contact requests

- Paid subscribers request an introduction via a form matching the spec: requester info, experience level, request type, message, timeline, and consent.
- Submissions route to the admin panel; admin can forward to the creative or mark accepted/declined.

Subscriptions

- \$30/year early-access rate (pre-launch signups) vs. \$50/year standard, enforced server-side.
- Stripe Checkout + Billing Portal are wired up, but **currently run in a safe demo mode** (below) since live keys aren't set.

Admin panel & tests

- Applications, contact requests, feature requests, and basic analytics (kept on a simple internal dark theme).
- Vitest suite (`npm test`) covering signup/login, enrollment, contact requests, feature requests, admin moderation, and checkout — 30 tests, all passing.

DEMO MODE (NO REAL CHARGES OR EMAILS YET)

With `STRIPE_SECRET_KEY` and `RESEND_API_KEY` unset:

- The subscribe page shows a "demo flow" banner and a "Simulate payment" button instead of real checkout. Clicking it marks the account paid (no money moves) and shows a success page noting the payment was simulated.
- Application / approval / rejection / contact-request emails silently no-op — the in-app success screens still show, but no email is sent.

So the site is fully demoable end-to-end today without either vendor account.

WHAT'S NEEDED BEFORE GOING LIVE

Stripe — subscription billing

Used for: charging the \$30/\$50 annual subscription, the self-serve billing portal (update card, cancel), and keeping subscription status in sync via webhooks.

1. Create a Stripe account and switch to live mode.
2. Create two recurring Prices: \$30/year ("early access") and \$50/year ("standard").
3. Set environment variables on the host:
 - `STRIPE_SECRET_KEY` — from the Stripe dashboard
 - `STRIPE_PRICE_EARLY` / `STRIPE_PRICE_STANDARD` — the two Price IDs
 - `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` — from a webhook endpoint pointed at `/api/webhooks/stripe`, listening for `customer.subscription.created/updated/deleted`
4. Once set, the demo banner disappears and real Checkout takes over — no code changes needed.

Resend — transactional email

Used for: notifying the team of new applications and contact requests, and notifying applicants/creatives of approval, rejection, and feature selection.

1. Create a Resend account.
2. Verify the sending domain (`aneesataalks.com`) by adding the DNS records Resend provides — required before it will deliver mail from `noreply@aneesataalks.com`.
3. Set `RESEND_API_KEY` on the host. Every email flow then activates automatically.

OTHER REQUIRED ENVIRONMENT VARIABLES

- `DATABASE_URL` — Supabase connection. **Use the pooler connection** (`...pooler.supabase.com:5432`), not the direct `db.<ref>.supabase.co` host (which is IPv6-only and won't resolve from many networks).
- `SESSION_SECRET` — random 32+ character string for signing login sessions.
- `NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL` — the deployed site URL (used in email links and Stripe redirects).

NOTE ON THE HEADER FONT

The spec calls for **Garet** (bold, all-caps, tight letter-spacing). Garet is a licensed font not available on Google Fonts, so **Plus Jakarta Sans (extrabold)** is substituted as the closest open-license match. If you license Garet, swapping it in is a small change in `src/app/layout.tsx`.